



Bulletproof clay

US Naval Research Laboratory has created a bulletproof material out of synthetic powdered clay <http://dgit.in/BulletpfClay>



Garbage scanner

GeniCan makes throwing garbage useful, by scanning whatever you throw and adding it to your grocery list <http://dgit.in/GeniCan>

Save yourselves: The Most Annoying Digital Habits

Read to know if your habits feature among some of the most annoying habits in the digital world. And then, knock it off!



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There are things that annoy all of us – road traffic, poor phone signal, long queues and slow restaurant service. We've been complaining about these for decades now. A new age is coming though, and a new age deserves new pet peeves. So guys, this is our #Digitrant. Remember, this is #just-forfun. We're not being #judgemental. But holy cow, these are #soannoying. #wearunningoutofhashtagshere.

If you haven't gotten the drift yet, our first annoying digital habit on the list is...

Excessive hashtags

Hashtags were introduced as an easy way to give context to a particular statement/post. They allow web aggregators to compile all posts relevant to a certain story quickly and easily, and this in turn makes stories easier to spread. But that was before hashtags became the 'in-thing'. Today, your typical Instagram caption is 10% words and 90% hashtags, including such inane tags as #thiswholephrase-

couldbeatag even though #theresnoway-thisgivescontexttoanything. Here's the thing: if your tag is so long and complicated that you're probably the only person using it, then it defeats the purpose of tags itself! This isn't as annoying as it is utterly pointless. What's even worse than this is the practice of #tagging #every #word #in #a #sentence. This can be extremely counterproductive as well, given that being sorted under #pirates, #of, #the, and #caribbean isn't quite the same as being sorted under #piratesofthecaribbean. Kids, this doesn't help spread the message and it doesn't make anything easier to read. Are you sure you want to be categorised by Twitter in the feed of the #the tag?
Annoyance Rating: #two #stars

Typng lyk diz

Leet speak became popular a long time ago, and until recently was still justified when SMSes had word limits per page. That's not a problem we face anymore in the day of the internet-based messenger. The usual argument by most people for continuing to use SMS lingo is that it saves time and effort. They don't realise, however, that the amount of effort it takes for the other person to understand what they're trying to say is twice as much as it would take for them to type that additional letter. Sometimes, even that claim doesn't stand true – "irrezytyble" instead of "irresistible", for example. Now you're just eager to use more Y's, and it shows. It's imperative that if you're reading this and still communicate using SMS lingo, you switch before Facebook starts offering translations for every word you type.